

KOHLRABI *Brassica oleracea* Gongylodes Group

Kohlrabi's combination of striking ornamental leaves and a bulbous, alien-looking stem is both bizarre and beautiful. The swollen purple, green, or white stems have a mild, sweet flavor, and can be cooked or eaten raw in salads. This fast-growing vegetable can be grown in containers, but is ideal for use as a catch crop. It should be sown successively, since it does not keep very well once harvested.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW/PLANT				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Kohlrabi will tolerate most soils, but it prefers a non-acidic pH, so consider adding lime to soil if the pH is much below 7. Sow under cover in early spring, or sow directly into the ground once the soil has warmed up. Kohlrabi needs a minimum temperature of 50°F (10°C) to prevent bolting.

Sow in modules at a depth of 1 in (2.5 cm), and plant the seedlings out before they reach 2 in (5 cm) tall, since this will also help to prevent bolting. When planting out, ensure that you leave at least 9 in (23 cm) between plants, and 12 in (30 cm) between rows. When sowing directly into the ground, thin out seedlings before they become too large or you risk damaging the roots.



Ensure that crops have space to develop.

Try sowing three seeds in each location, and then remove the weakest two once the seedlings have established. Plant faster-growing green and white varieties first and introduce slower purple varieties later.

CROP CARE

Ensure that you weed and water regularly—if kohlrabi dries out it becomes woody and unpalatable.